

DAILY PROGRESS / PREPARED FOR RICK

A place to work. A room worth building.

The website is now organized around Rick's artwork, feedback and daily progress. The drawing work is moving back to a measured bare room, so each later piece can be improved without disturbing the rest.

1,641

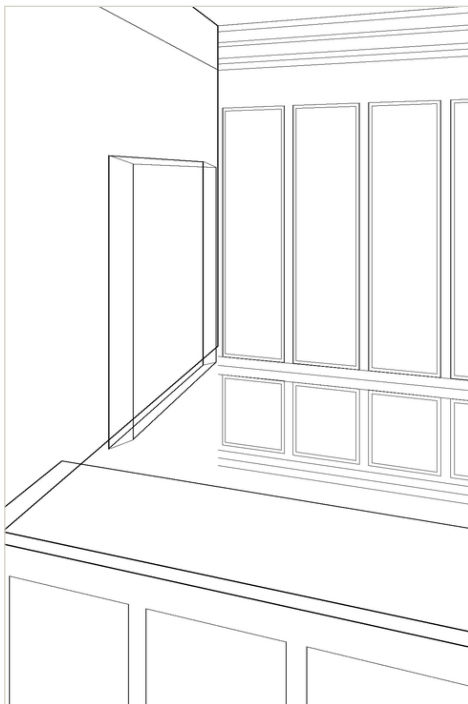
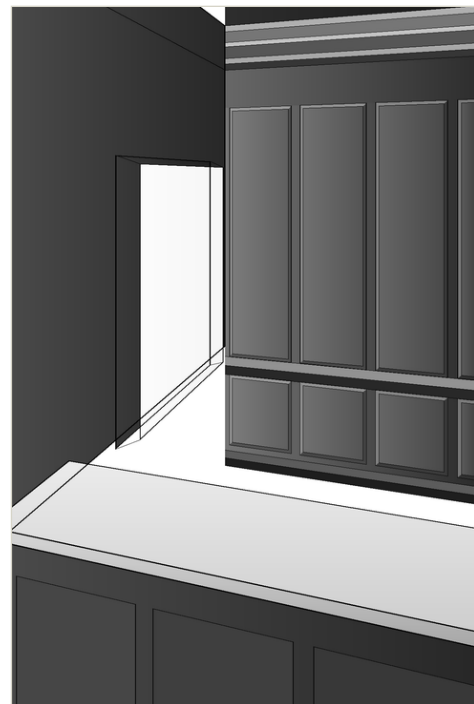
images in the saved library

13

room studies in this report

0

GitHub commits dated today

**TONIGHT: CONSTRUCTION****TONIGHT: LIGHT AND SHADE**

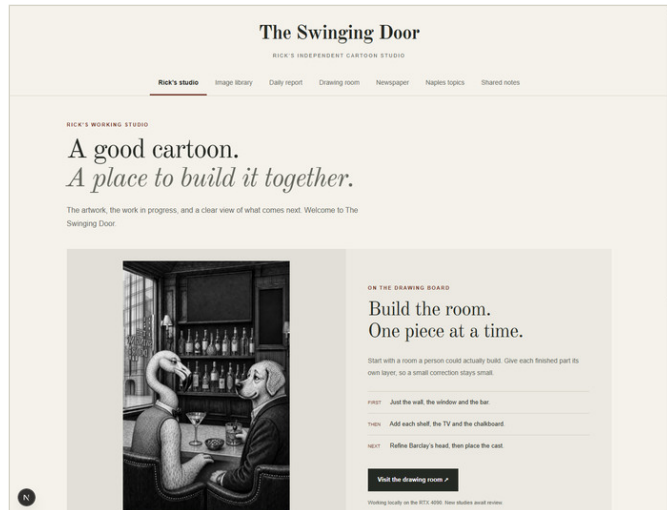
Current planning drawings, frozen at 8:43 p.m. Eastern. Both remain unapproved.

What Rick should know: the redesigned site is available as a private preview. The usual website address still shows the earlier release. The room, cast refinements and daily automatic creation are still works in progress.

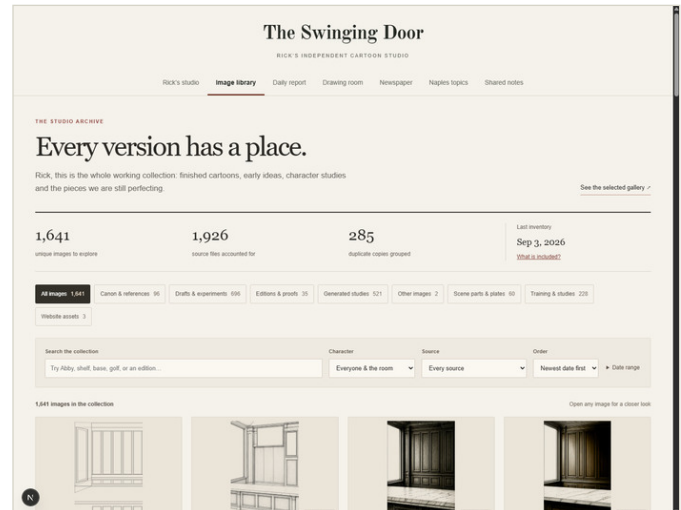
THE WEBSITE

Rick's working studio

Actual screenshots of the local working site, captured today. The saved archive includes earlier work; these are not 1,641 new drawings made today.



Home: Rick's branding and the current drawing plan.



Library: search, cast filters, dates and image history.

The archive is easier to use

1,926 source files resolve to 1,641 unique images; 285 duplicate copies are grouped. Images can be found by cast, category, source and date.

Characters have their own organization

1,126 images have cast tags supported by source metadata. Multi-character scenes appear under each relevant cast member. Unidentified images remain visible.

A calmer, clearer design

Rick is the named studio owner. The home page leads into artwork, reports, the drawing room, newspaper, topics and shared notes.

Daily reports show the evidence

GitHub changes are explained in plain English with the relevant images. Local unfinished work is listed separately from committed work.

Notes stay with the conversation

Private shared notes can include an image, a topic and the writer's name. A note can be attached directly to the picture being discussed.

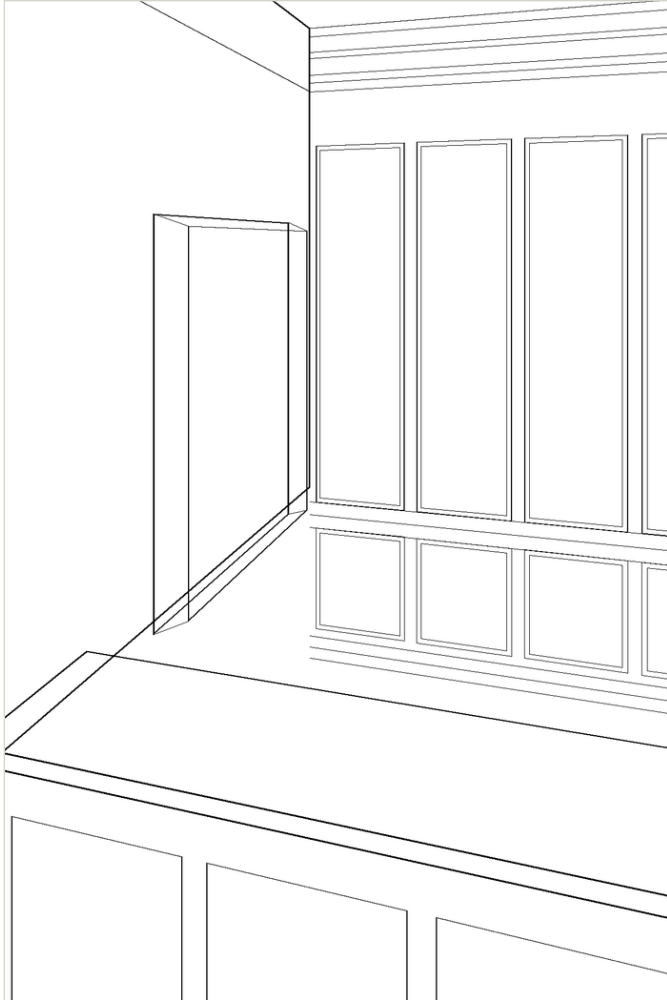
The useful limits are visible

Hosted viewing copies are available; exact originals remain local. New parts are not silently approved, and the website cannot yet trigger this PC's GPU remotely.

CURRENT ART / EVENING REVISION

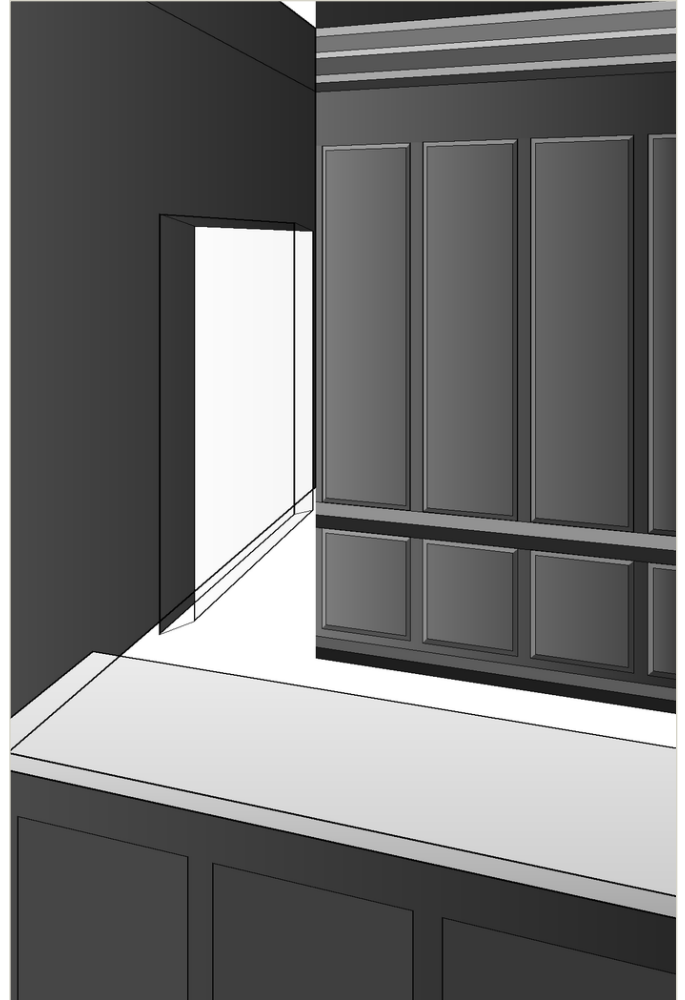
Start with a room a person could build.

The base is wall, window and bar only. No shelves, television, chalkboard, scenery or characters are approved additions at this stage.



01 MEASURED CONSTRUCTION

One camera and physical room measurements establish the panel bays, window opening and counter. The angled view is being preserved while proportions are adjusted.



02 SHARED LIGHTING PLAN

A common set of light and dark values gives every later part the same starting point. It reduces drift; it does not replace an artist's inspection.

Status: these are the 8:43 p.m. planning snapshots. The earlier material render on the next page uses older geometry; it is not the finished result of these two drawings.

EARLIER TODAY / EXPERIMENTS

What the room studies taught us.

These images record the afternoon's material and construction experiments. They remain candidates, and the evening geometry work has moved beyond them.

**Strip back the old scene**

An early attempt to remove furnishings and expose the room.

**Make the joinery readable**

Wood grain follows each member, with clearer panel fields and rails.

**Render from light and shade**

A promising material study, with counter and window details still unresolved.

WHAT STILL REQUIRES AN ARTIST'S EYE

Construction

Counter depth and support, believable window thickness, clean wall junctions and consistent panel joints.

Mark-making

Wood grain must follow the boards. Hatching, edge weight and fur texture must hold together at newspaper size.

Image cleanup

The earlier rendered candidate has faint guide lines in the window. Those are defects to remove before approval.

THE METHOD / LOCAL RTX 4090

Build the picture in replaceable parts.

The parts machinery exists. The new room still has to be approved before those parts can be fitted and judged against it.



1. Approve the bare structure

Set the angle, proportions, wall, window and counter. Keep an unchanged approved starting point.

2. Render a part in context

Show the whole room to the local model, but keep only the pixels inside that part's carefully drawn boundary.

3. Inspect, then assemble

Check perspective, light, edges and pen strokes. Replace only the selected part and compare the result.

4. Add the cast and words

Fit the recurring characters after the room works. Add exact captions with controlled typesetting.

Earlier assembly experiment using the old room. It demonstrates the parts workflow; it is not the new bare base or an approved finished cartoon.

STILL TO BUILD AND REFINE

Room: upper shelf, lower shelf, wall corner, TV and chalkboard.

Street: modern New York, a hot-dog stand and indistinct people.

Cast: Barclay's head and ear, then a properly reviewed Abby.

Connection: local generation is the policy; a hosted studio-to-PC workflow still needs work.

NEWSPAPER / CORRECTED TODAY

Drew and Barclay take the page.

The rejected Abby rendering has been removed from the newspaper. The replacement is existing archive artwork A01, selected today and paired with its original caption.

THE NAPLES EDITION

OPINION / MARKETS / EVERYDAY LIFE

The Swinging Door

Thursday, September 3, 2026

OPINION & PERSPECTIVE

PAGE 1

THE EDITORIAL PAGE

Where the headlines meet the household.

The numbers make the news. What we make of them is another story.

The price of paying attention

From the editor's desk

A financial headline can travel halfway around the world before it reaches the kitchen table. By then, it has acquired a different unit of measurement: a monthly payment, an insurance renewal or the price on a familiar menu.

That is where this page begins. The economy is more than a chart on a screen. It is also the small calculation before a decision and the conversation that follows it.

In Naples, there is room for a financial cartoon that recognizes those conversations without turning every reader into an analyst. A good drawing needs an observation. A good caption leaves something for the reader to discover.

A smaller stage

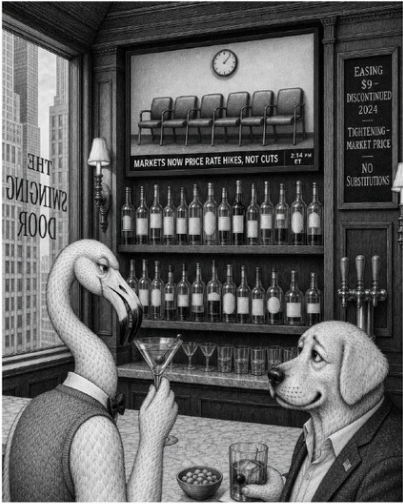
The Swinging Door gives that conversation a room of its own. Drew supplies the dry observation. Barclay brings the bill back to human scale. Abby has heard enough of both to know when the discussion is over.

The bar is a setting for the joke, not its subject. The subject is the distance between an announcement and the ordinary day it eventually reaches.

There is no need to shout across that distance. Sometimes the quietest sentence carries furthest.

The Swinging Door

AN EDITORIAL CARTOON



A number is only the beginning

A house can have a market value, an assessed value and a taxable value. An insurance quote can look simple until the coverage is compared. A familiar asking price can imply an unfamiliar payment.

Those distinctions are worth explaining. They are also fertile ground for a cartoon, provided the joke rests on the difference itself and not on somebody's misfortune.

What earns a place here

A specific observation. A clear visual scene. Characters with different ways of seeing the same piece of news. A line short enough to read once and interesting enough to read again.

The point is recognition: that slight pause when a reader realizes the person at the next stool has been doing the same arithmetic.

Three seats. One conversation.

Drew
The measured observer.

Barclay
The number on the receipt.

Abby
The last word, when needed.

Barclay: "I don't mind a rate hike. I'd just like two years of waiting for a cut counted as time served."

THE SWINGING DOOR / ARCHIVE ARTWORK A01

*"The conversation is local.
The absurdity travels."*

THE SWINGING DOOR / NAPLES EDITORIAL DESIGN PROOF

ORIGINAL SAMPLE COPY / NOT A PUBLISHED EDITION

What changed

The web newspaper and downloadable 11 x 17 PDF now use a Drew-and-Barclay-only cartoon. The image, credit and caption match.

The rejected rendering

The specific Abby likeness in B03 is recorded as rejected. It must not be used as a model for approved Abby artwork.

What this proves

The cartoon can be judged in an editorial page: column width, caption size, surrounding text and grayscale balance.

Still a layout proof

This is not an issued newspaper. Final publication needs the newspaper's actual column width, image resolution and grayscale specifications.

Barclay: "I don't mind a rate hike. I'd just like two years of waiting for a cut counted as time served."

NAPLES / EDITORIAL DIRECTION

Research first. Daily cartoons later.

The long-term aim is a local financial cartoon informed by search interest and actual audience response. Today's work establishes a research desk, not an automatic publishing system.

GOOGLE TRENDS: OBSERVED SEPTEMBER 3

The research used the Ft. Myers-Naples metro, Web Search, all categories, and the past 90 days. Naples-city results were insufficient. These are relative growth labels, not search-volume totals or proof of readership. Google labels growth above 5,000% "Breakout."

PROPERTY TAX

"property tax exemption florida"

+80%

A possible joke about the difference between a house's market, assessed and taxable values.

HOME INSURANCE

"home insurance quotes florida"

+50%

A possible joke about what a quote appears to promise and what the actual coverage contains.

MORTGAGE RATES

"what are the current mortgage rates"

Breakout

A possible joke about waiting for lower rates while an ordinary purchase cannot wait forever.

GOOGLE ANALYTICS: NO REPORT CONNECTED

The intended GA4 property still needs to be identified. No metrics from unrelated businesses were imported. Search interest and website behavior will remain separate sources.

Future sequence: save dated research → choose a relevant angle → draft a short caption → generate locally from the approved scene → inspect → prepare for publication.

RECORD / WHAT IS SAVED WHERE

Today's work, without overstating it.

GitHub, local files and deployed previews tell different parts of the story. This report keeps those records separate.

GitHub commits dated September 3	0 across all 5 remote branches
Commit history inspected	1,290 unique commits; 1,285 on main
Open pull requests / today's merges	0 / 0 at the audit cutoff
Latest main commit	9eebda2 - September 2, 12:19 p.m. Eastern
Local working snapshot	36 tracked files changed, plus untracked art and report files
Website release status	Private preview ready; usual address remains on prior release

Audit cutoff: 8:44 p.m. Eastern. Both author and commit dates were checked. Zero commits today does not mean zero work: the overhaul, art studies and previews have not yet been committed to GitHub. The working-file count includes earlier unfinished work; a file timestamp does not prove a new generation.

CURRENT TASK LIST / NEXT ORDER OF WORK

- NOW

Finish and review the measured bare room and common lighting.
- NEXT

Fit separate shelves, fixtures and New York street view; refine Barclay and Abby.
- THEN

Confirm the GA4 property, final newspaper specifications and main-site rollout.
- LATER

Connect the hosted studio to local generation and build a reliable daily workflow.

Claude handles the art pipeline; ChatGPT handles the studio, reports and newspaper. Decisions and file ownership are recorded in the shared repository handoff.

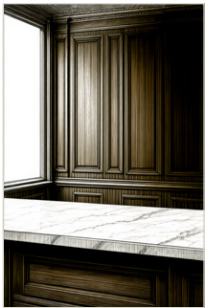
APPENDIX / IMAGE RECORD

The room studies saved today.

All 13 PNGs present in room-kit/v2 at the report snapshot. “Saved today” includes planning and lighting variants; it is not a count of approved artworks or separate model generations.



01-base-strip-s1.png



01-base-strip-s2.png



01-base-strip-s5.png



02-base-scratch-s2.png



02-base-scratch-s5.png



04-panelling-s1.png



04-panelling-s4.png



06-from-values-s1.png



06-from-values-s4.png



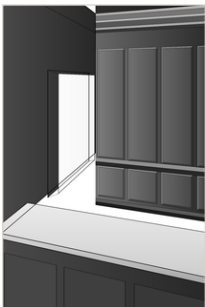
01-values-B.png



01-values-C.png



00-lines.png



01-values.png

SOURCES AND READING LINKS

[GitHub repository / commit history](#) | [Current studio preview](#)
[Google Trends: Ft. Myers-Naples research](#) | [Collier property-value guide](#)
Working sources: docs/AGENTS-HANDOFF.md; scripts/draw-room-lines.py; canon/plates/parts.json; lib/studio-library-manifest.json;
docs/naples-topics-research-2026-09-03.md.
Audit files: tmp/daily-report-2026-09-03/{git-audit,art-audit}.json. Frozen images retain source times and SHA-256 hashes. Library snapshot: 3:37 p.m.; geometry: 8:43 p.m.; local screenshots: 8:45 p.m. Eastern. Preview requires studio access; the main site was not promoted.